

Significance of African Music as a Tool for National Development: Conceptual Discourse

By

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Abstract

This article investigates the role of music in Africa. to achieve this, Cultural Nationalism Theory and qualitative research design are employed as guide. The study is primarily motivated by the fact that music plays an indispensable role in the being of Africans at work, in politics, in their socio- economic engagements, in religious worship, integral development, in their moral life, etc. Indigenous music is a way of life that carries the attributes and value of the culture it identifies and repositions sanity and sanctity in the African societies. This type of music provides utilitarian education, information, entertainment and cultural enlightenment. It uplifts the soul of the citizenry in a hard economic situation and serves as an effective repository of indigenous knowledge systems, collective memory, and social philosophy. It corrects and helps to discipline people's behaviour thereby contributing effectively for national development. Regrettably, increasingly, focus is shifting from the traditional music in developing the nation or preserving the cultural heritage of the Nation. Attention is then being given to borrowed culture in the name of civilization. The paper concludes by noting that considering the ultimate underscores the indispensability of African music as a dynamic system of knowledge is in the African mythodology and a catalyst for cultural resilience, and a cornerstone of identity and self-definition in both local and diasporic contexts, it is therefore highly recommended for the improvement on the study of the subject in Nigerian schools for national development.

Keywords: Significance, African Music, Tradition, Tool, National Development.

Introduction

Black Africa according to Celestine Chukwuemeka Mbaegbu (2015) shows certain cultural unity. This is the consequences of analogous existential experiences of life in an isolated and difficult environment. This phenomenon according to Celestine has slowly produced a unified African world distinct from and comparable with Western and Asian worlds. And with the end of the Second World War the African wishes to become conscious of himself as a being in the African world and to live with that consciousness, and consequently, his culture, his being and total environment have become very significant to him.

It is within the diverse cultural landscapes of Africa, music functions as a fundamental repository of indigenous knowledge systems and collective memory. Far beyond serving as a form of entertainment or mere sonic art, music in African traditions according to Sylvanus Kwashie Kuwor (2025) embodies cosmological, historical, social, and philosophical dimensions that are integral to the lived experiences and worldviews of various communities. Sylvester further noted that scholars such as J.H. Kwabena Nketia (1974), Modesto Amegago (2011), Kwadzo Avorgbedor (2001), Kofi Agawu (1995), Kofi Gbolonyo (2009), and Sylvanus

Kwashie Kuwor (2013) have extensively examined the multi-layered nature of African music, offering critical insights into its role as a holistic art form that synthesises sound, movement, ritual, and social communication.

These scholarly contributions according to Sylvester affirm that African music is not an isolated aesthetic phenomenon but is deeply embedded in cultural performance, identity formation, oral tradition, and intergenerational knowledge transfer. This paper draws on these foundational perspectives to argue for a reconceptualisation of music in Africa as an integrated art form that intersects with dance, language, spirituality, visual forms and social organisation. By engaging with the work of these key scholars, the study foregrounds the importance of treating African music as a dynamic cultural expression that transcends auditory boundaries and serves as a vehicle for sustaining and transmitting cultural knowledge, values, ethical principles, and historical consciousness, which makes it more distinct amongst its contemporaries (Sylvester, 2025).

Even so, Celestine in his article had earlier stated that there is now African philosophy quite distinct from Western, Indian, Asian and even American philosophy. While quoting Césaire (1972), Celestine (2015) aver that "We also talk of African Art, Literature, Poetry, Music, etc. In short, since the end of the cold war, Africans are determined that they are “black and proud of it” and are also determined to show the world that Africa is not some sort of blank sheet in the history of world's contribution to rich cultural values and heritage. Césaire according to Celestine still went further to state “its values are values that can still make an important contribution to the world”.

It is the contention of the author of this article that African music is another area of Africa's great contributions to world civilization and recreational facilities, and that Africans are notoriously music lovers. Music permeates into all the various aspects of their lives. Various African writers have highlighted this aspect of the cultural life of the Africans by saying that music has rooted itself in African culture so much so that it has become part and parcel of their everyday life. Some maintain that more than any other continent in the world the African is jovial, light hearted, emotional and sensitive to music. Little wonder his manual work, his recreational periods, his suffering moments, etc. are punctuated with music. For instance, at the birth of a child he/she is received into the community amidst dancing, rejoicing and songs of jubilation (Banisudha, 2024).

The same music features in driving and in moments of sorrows and joys. For instance, the ceremony of a genius in any spheres of human endeavors, at funerals, launchings of all sorts, initiation ceremonies, etc., even at the battle fields including the field of soccer, music dominates the life of the African. In almost all the denominational churches and even in the Catholic Church music has become an inseparable handmaid of worship (Celestine, 2015). Put simply, African music according to Celestine is one of the cultural characteristics that make the African who he is as a distinct cultural being in the world, for it binds Africans together and gives them common characteristics. In this article, therefore, having established that music is not alien or extraneous to the Africans but part of their culture, I shall address ourselves to the nature and role of music in the integral development of Africans especially in their social life, in politics, in guiding his moral, religious and integral development of the African person. Secondly, we shall critically examine as much as possible different types of African music but not in isolation with

the roles they play in African society. Thirdly, we shall try to establish the basis of African morality, that is to say, in African society what makes a given act right or wrong, and finally we shall see if there is any relationship between African music and morality (Celestine, 2015).

Understanding the Concept of Music in an African Perspective

In African traditions, the understanding of music transcends the limitations often imposed by Western definitions. Unlike the Western conceptualization, where music is typically viewed as a distinct and isolated activity, African music according to Sylvester (2025) exists as an integrated and dynamic part of communal life. It is not merely a sonic experience but rather a rich, multilayered expression that encompasses sound, movement, emotion, and cultural identity. African music emerges from a deep cultural and social framework where it is interwoven with rituals, ceremonies, and the day-to-day experiences of the people. Music is a living, breathing entity, inseparable from the community's spiritual and social practices. This is why, across the diverse African languages and cultures, there is no single term that neatly captures the essence of music in the Western sense. Instead, the concept of music in Africa incorporates a spectrum of interconnected activities including drumming, singing, dancing, storytelling and dramatic enactment all of which come together to form a cohesive and holistic expression of shared life and collective identity of a people (Sylvester, 2025).

In the Anlo-Ewe tradition, for example, the word *wu* serves as a prime illustration of what the people believe and practice as music. The word according to Sylvester does not merely refer to music as an auditory phenomenon but embodies an entire performance that integrates singing, drumming, dancing, storytelling and the use of visual forms in semiotic communication. These elements are seen as inseparable, all contributing equally to the creation of *wu*. The drum, also referred to as *wu*, is central to the performance, symbolizing the fundamental role that rhythm and percussion play in the various African musical traditions. This holistic understanding of music as a collective experience highlights the significant role each element plays in building the full expression of African musical culture. The artificial separation of these components, as often done in Western music studies, is not just unfamiliar but incompatible with the African worldview, where music cannot be detached from its accompanying movements, gestures, and communal participation (Sylvester, 2025).

Historically, this holistic nature of African music according to Sylvester was not fully respected or understood in early research conducted by Western scholars. Pioneers of African music scholarship such as A.M. Jones (1959), J.H. Kwabena Nketia (1974), Bebey (1975), David Locke (1978), and John Miller Chernoff (1979), although instrumental in documenting African music, approached their studies from a Western ethnomusicological framework (Sylvester, 2025). Even though some scholars, such as Mawere Opoku, who was instrumental in the institutionalisation of dance in Ghana, recognised the deep connection between music and dance, the broader scholarly community failed to grasp the importance of this relationship. Opoku's (1965) according to Bammer (2013) definition of dance includes music and other related arts creating the holistic nature of what could be termed as African performance making. The tendency to view music as an isolated art form, divorced from its physical and cultural context, led to a vast body of academic work that did not fully represent the richness of African musical traditions. The focus on studying the "musical" components without acknowledging the integral role of dance movements, gestures, and the socio-cultural environment, created an

incomplete and often misleading narrative about African music.

Sylvester also noted that "this resulted in the underrepresentation of key aspects of African performance art and a misunderstanding of the full scope of what music means within African societies". More recent scholarship, particularly by African scholars or those with close ties to African cultures, has begun to challenge and redress these earlier limitations. Researchers such as Kofi Agawu (2003), Kwadzo Avorgbedor (2001), Paschal Younge (2011), Modesto Amegago (2011), Kofi Gbolonyo (2009), Iddrisu (2011), Elikem Nyamuame (2013) and Sylvanus Kwashie Kuwor (2013) according to Bammer (2013). have worked to bridge the gap between the study of African music and its intrinsic connection to dance, language, and cultural identity. These scholars emphasise that any study of African music that fails to account for its integration with dance and the social practices surrounding it is incomplete. They argue for a broader, more inclusive understanding of African music in a context that recognises its role not only as an auditory art form but also as a physical, emotional, and cultural experience. This shift in perspective underscores the importance of studying African music in its entirety thereby embracing its connections to dance, ritual, social functions, and the community's worldview (Bammer, 2013).

In essence, the work of these scholars highlights that African music is not merely about sound production; it is about the totality of the experience. The singing, drumming, dancing, and the communal context within which these activities occur all contribute to what music truly means in African societies. By reclaiming the holistic nature of African music, modern scholars aim to present a fuller, more authentic representation of the traditions and cultural expressions that have been shaped by centuries of practice and belief. African music, in this sense, is an embodiment of cultural identity, spirituality, and community as a living tradition that cannot be fully appreciated without understanding the deep interconnections between its various components (Sylvester, 2025).

Types and Roles of African Music

Mother Africa can be said to be a land of diverse music, and any type of African music plays a vital role, hence the existence of such, because Africans believe that the purpose of anything give meaning and existence to the thing itself. Mother Africa hosts three categories of music among which are traditional, popular and classical. Traditional music includes all traditional or folk music that serve as media of expression of African people's culture and according to Nwamara (2009) according to Celestine (2015) they are being transmitted orally from one generation to another.

In its transmission process, allowances are made for each generation to make selections and variations from the original composition without destroying its tone of continuity. The music and its practitioners are found in greater number in the rural areas. Their composers are not known because the music/s is/are communally owned. Then there is the popular music generally referred to as "pop" music which is a contemporaneous music, which appeals to a mass audience and is dance oriented. Popular music found in Africa is coeval and Western (Celestine, 2015). The genres of popular music in Africa according to Celestine fall under three categories: the derivatives of traditional music, e.g. the Nigerian apala, sakara, akuko n'egwu, and dadakuada; Those that reflect interaction between local and Western/ Arabic musical

cultures like highlife, juju, fuji and ajasco; The Western popular mainstream and those that result from interaction between Africa and New World Cultures: the Afro-American Forms-reggae, raga rap, Afro-beat or Afro-rock, soul, Congo music, disco, electronic and jazz-rock, and Ozzidi. The last of the three classes of music in Africa is the Classical Music (Anderson, 2016).

Classical here according to Celestine means all written music composed in accordance with certain universally accepted conventions and rules. In more recent times precisely with the advent of democracy as a political ideology in Africa, a new class of music springs up which can be described as Political music. Political music falls within the three classes of music in Africa and can appear in any of the three. The primary determinant here is the lyrics/text of the song. Consequently, Nwamara: (2009) according to Celestine (2015) asserts that “political music exists in various forms as “one track music in an album, a complete album, electioneering campaign song, jingles, state or town or party songs/anthems, rally songs, and spontaneous compositions”.

One of the types of African music is the signaling type. This is seen in different categories of African peoples: children, boys, girls, men and women. Almost at the tail end of the third millennium, Nketia (1975) according to Celestine (2015) writes on this type of music as follows: “When children assist in the economic activities of their parents or are given special responsibilities, such as looking after flocks, they may be encouraged to play flutes for their own enjoyment, for giving signals to their companions, or for guiding their flock”. Among the adult folk, when a man dies the big wooden drum (Ikolo) bellows, signaling the death of someone and in a space of time, listening to it the name of the dead could be heard.

In this, the signaling type of music according to Celestine serves the role of disseminating information in most African societies. For the adult African, music is the sole of life. It permeates all his daily activities ranging from domestic affairs like grinding snuff, pounding, building hunting, ploughing, tapping fishing, etc; all grounded on the fact that not only manual labor that puts the fruits of the field at man's disposal. Sowing and reaping are only parts of human activity. Man must do more than sow and reap; speech and song must be added, for it is the combination of words and songs and voices that make the seed corn to germinate and grow, the cows go in calf and give milk, the hymns of praise sung by the sorcerer while the goldsmith is working the gold completes the work and makes it a masterpiece (Celestine, 2015).

Thus all the activities of men, and all movements in nature among the African according to Celestine are accompanied with songs. Indeed, all change; all production and generation are believed to be effected through the word and music. We have recreational, entertainment and aesthetic enjoyment type like the Mkpokiti (acrobatic music of Nigeria). Among the types of African music are the religious music, war music, praise music, highlife music, Afro- beat music, folk music, etc. The role of music in African society depends on the type of music. Religious music inspires the worshippers to express their loyalty to the deity.

African religious hymns according to Appadurai (2006) have triple functions: Reparation, Thanksgiving and Petition. Apart from these, most religious hymns teach good morals, underlying the necessity of virtuous deeds and denouncing evil acts. By this function, African composers particularly composers of highlife and philosophical tunes serve to re-direct the straying society through their music, for example, Mike Ejeagha's Onye Mkpesa and Celestine

Ukwu's Asili Ajoka (Anderson, 2016). Sunny Okoson's is today both philosophical and religious but before now his appearances over the telecast were in no way commendable, etc. On the other hand there are some African musicians, who, due to outside influence, either American or European have turned their brand of music as medium for propagating and disseminating doctrines of licentiousness, sexual liberalism and moral indifference. Such brands of music were exemplified in late Fela's Afro band and his lover girls (Appadurai, 2006).

Apart from religious music, Nettle (1956 in Celestine, 2015) adds that: Africans have war music sung during war periods and at the war front. The role of music during periods of war is to solicit supernatural assistance, ensure success while that sung by soldiers at war fronts, encourages soldiers to move into the battle field confident that victory is theirs. Among the [Igbo] of Nigeria, there is incantation which emboldens their spirit and summons them to action. The [Igbo] people are like the elephant. In folk tales or story telling brands, the pre-modern Africans equally indulged in music to entertain and re- create themselves. The highlife brand with its philosophical import relaxes the soul, gladdens the heart, upholding moral behavior and opens the eyes of the Africans to the goings-on in the African universe. In political life of the African, music is not relegated to the background. There are praise songs and music to get the better part of the leaders of various communities and various state governors including any constituted authority. Wealthy men and craftsmen not excluded.

Cultural Nationalism Theory

Cultural Nationalism Theory is a perspective that emphasizes the importance of a nation's culture, tradition, arts, and heritage as the foundation of national identity, unity and development. It posits that a people can achieve meaningful progress when they preserve, promote, and take pride in their indigenous culture.

The theory is often associated with scholar and nationalist thinkers such as Johann Gottfried Herder in the late 18th century, particularly between 1770 and 1800. Johan argues that every nation possesses a unique cultural spirit expressed through its language, music, folklore, and traditions. This paper adopts this theory because its main focus is towards advocating that culture is the foundation of national identity; indigenous cultural values should be preserved and promoted; cultural heritage strengthens unity among citizens; national development is enhanced when people identify with and value their cultural traditions, and arts, including music, play a vital role in nation building.

Methodology

Methodology in science refers to the diverse principles, procedures, and practices that govern empirical research. It is useful to distinguish five major components to convey the scope of the topics and to organize the subject matter. This paper adopts Qualitative approach to research because it concerned with the interrogation of subjective assessment of attitudes, opinions and behaviour as pertains the Significance of African Music and National Development. It further makes use of secondary data, such as reputable journals, textbooks, articles and lecture notes. And primary data such as the writer's basic idea of the population area.

Music as an integral part of Culture

Music is generally defined as an organized sound that has its concept varying from one society to another. Everybody in every culture recognizes music when he hears one or needs it. Furthermore, music is culturebound, meaning that every culture decides on what is music; therefore it is culture that gives music its definition, this was corroborated by Jagga (1974) when he explains that "ociologically, the concept of music is defined by the society and it is concerned with the organized ways in which people behave towards one another when they listen, produce, and reproduce those sounds which they perceive as music".

This implies that a specific sound that is regarded as music to a particular culture may have no music meaning to another culture. In other words, what is accepted as music to one culture may represent an ordinary sound to another culture. Okafor (2005) according to Ogunrinade (2015) reiterates this by saying that "it is only when the sounds have been organized by man so as to achieve certain effects or express certain ideas or emotion that we call that music". Expression of certain ideas or emotion is very important in definition of music because man must have an objective for organizing the sound

It is the culture that determines what is accepted as music to its people. Music can be referred to as an expression or art that is most accessible to human beings in any situation in their lives—crisis or calm, work and worship play or war, recreation or reflection (Okafor 2005 in Ogunrinade, 2015). It is used as a medium of communication, to express ideas, emotions and melancholies. Also to move, mobilize people and rally them to solidarity. Music is a cultural expression, a phenomenon that is part of communal or cultural activities. Confirming this assertion, Ogunrinade observed that....a society's continued expression of her socio-musical being, doing, spirit, feeling, beliefs and values is perceptible in both the content (e.g. material traditions, practices) as well as the process (e.g. daily living, spirit, communication).

It is an event that expresses and carries forward the action in the activity. The cultural activity's meaning is partly embodied in the music that is part of it. To this end, its study implies the study of the associated activities. Does this sit well with education providers and sponsors? If not, how can the academia accommodate the prevailing attitude all of which is related to perception of music? One needs to remember that music is a way of knowing.

Again, in African setting, nothing important happens without music (Senoga-Zake in Akuno 2010). It is also an economic activity both at personal and national levels, music products and production are a means of employment. Many who decline a music offering in the curriculum are unaware of music's potential. The music industry is a thriving one, and needs personnel equipped with knowledge, skills and attitudes that will make it a reliable player in the economy.

Music Education and Cultural Identity

The research findings provide compelling evidence that music education significantly impacts the development and sustenance of cultural identity among Nigerian students, fostering a deeper understanding and appreciation of their heritage. Both formal and informal approaches to music education contribute to this outcome, albeit with varying degrees of effectiveness and reach.

In formal education settings, where indigenous music is systematically integrated, students demonstrate an enhanced awareness of their cultural roots. Interviews with students revealed that learning traditional songs, rhythms, and the history behind specific musical forms instilled a sense of pride and connection. For instance, a secondary school student in Enugu noted, "Before, I only listened to pop music. But learning Igbo highlife and traditional chants in school made me appreciate my culture more. It feels like learning about my ancestors." Educators who effectively incorporated local instruments and performance practices reported increased engagement and cultural confidence among their pupils. However, the study also found that the effectiveness of formal programs is often limited by curriculum biases towards Western music and a lack of adequately trained teachers in indigenous music, echoing challenges highlighted in the literature review.

Informal music education, predominantly through family, community events, and cultural groups, plays an equally, if not more, vital role in shaping cultural identity. Observations of festivals, ceremonies, and local gatherings consistently showed music as the central medium for transmitting cultural narratives, values, and social norms. Children participating in these events, often through imitation and direct mentorship from elders, internalize their cultural identity organically. A cultural practitioner in Kaduna emphasized, "Our children learn their identity through the drum, through the dance, through the stories in our songs. This happens at home, at celebrations, every day." This hands-on, immersive learning fosters a robust sense of belonging and cultural continuity that formal settings sometimes struggle to replicate due to their structured nature.

Overall, the data suggests that effective promotion of cultural identity through music education is strongest when formal curricula acknowledge and build upon the rich informal learning experiences. Current programs are most effective when they bridge this gap, utilizing indigenous musical resources and pedagogies that resonate with students' lived cultural realities, thereby reinforcing their appreciation for their unique Nigerian heritage.

The Role of Music in Cultural Preservation

A significant finding is how music acts as a primary medium for transmitting intricate cultural knowledge, including history, genealogy, and social etiquette. For instance, among the Yoruba, *Oriki* (praise poetry) embedded in songs narrates ancestral lineages, heroic deeds, and the characteristics of families and individuals. As one community elder from Osun State eloquently stated during an interview, "Music is our unwritten textbook. Through songs, our children learn who they are, where they come from, and the stories of our ancestors. It's how our history lives on." Similarly, Igbo traditional chants and proverbs, often sung, impart ancient wisdom and societal norms, ensuring their longevity beyond oral recitation alone (Okechukwu, 2025).

Furthermore, the study found that music is deeply intertwined with the transmission of core cultural values and spiritual beliefs. Many Nigerian songs carry moral lessons, according to Davis (2018) emphasize communal living, respect for elders, honesty, and hard work. For example, traditional Hausa praise songs for emirs and leaders not only celebrate achievements but also subtly reinforce the values of good governance and societal responsibility. A music educator in Kano noted, "When we teach traditional songs, we're not just teaching notes; we're teaching respect, community spirit, and the sacredness of our traditions. The melodies carry the

soul of our people." Ritualistic and ceremonial music, prevalent in countless ethnic groups, directly connects individuals to their spiritual heritage and belief systems, serving as an irreplaceable component of religious and communal rites of passage (Davis, 2025).

Observations also confirmed that participation in musical performances, from communal festivals to everyday work songs, reinforces group identity and cohesion. The collective singing and dancing foster a strong sense of belonging, ensuring the active perpetuation of cultural practices and shared heritage. This active engagement, rather than passive reception, solidifies the preservation efforts, (Anderson, 2016).

Significance of African Music

Music according to Offor Ndubuaku Kate and Popbon Daido Taoh (2025) serves as a universal language that transcends cultural and language barriers, bringing people together, fostering a sense of unity and curbing societal instability. It has the power to evoke emotions, bond individuals and communities, and promote social coherence. Every problem in the world has a root cause, according to Ali (2013 in Offor & Poplbon (2025) asserted that societal instability in any nation constitute threat to lives and properties, hinder business activities and discourage local and foreign investors which invariably slow down economic growth and development. Nigeria in recent times has recorded unprecedented security challenges such as Boko Haram Terrorists (BHTs) attacks, militancy, armed robbery, banditry, kidnapping for ransom, Fulani-Herders farmers clashes, cultism among other social vices (Offor & Poplbon, 2025).

These deviations manifest themselves in various ways and colours over time and under various circumstances. A peaceful country or individual does not exist. To bring peace, wars are fought, people are killed, and cultures are destroyed to preserve cultures. There are still more conflicts and more killings as a result of each conflict. No amount of wealth, political influence, or military might will be sufficient to bring about world peace (Jega, 2002). African musical concerts were a remarkable example of nation building for Ali (2013), as Christian and Muslim performers were seated next to each other. For him, true music can only be formed when life is reduced to a single tune and a single beat; he constantly repeats this sentiment. He was always emphatic that music is made a compulsory subject in schools (Offor & Poplbon, 2025).

African music according to Banisudha (2024) is regarded as a sacred and powerful art form in a religious gathering, and the need to revitalize this art form, the state, and the nation was reinforced. If we take a broad interpretation of music, that is, if we understand it as union, concord, and cooperation, then we can conclude that it is needed in no field of life. As a result, if many more people send their children to music classes, they will be contributing to national elevation. African music must be a part of our national awakening effort.

In other words, Banisudha further noted that African Music may no longer have to strive if children grow up in their natural innocence: we may be able to live in a world governed by love and harmony. And African music is without a doubt a weapon that can be used to reach this lofty goal. He advocated for making African music a compulsory subject in schools because he considered it a constructive activity that uplifts the soul and leaves no place for societal differences or enmity (Ali, 2013).

Therefore, Africans according to Banisudha (2024) live in a world governed by love and peace.

And African music is unquestionably a tool that may be used to achieve this great goal. Because he saw African music as a constructive activity that uplifts the soul and leaves no room for social divisions or hostility, he recommended making it a compulsory subject in our schools. Some Nigerian artists, on the other hand, according to Ali (2013) have developed works of art based on the national patriotism. With these compositions, the country has become much more unified and united together as a whole. Most Nigerian citizens adore the songs and other musical creations created by Nigerian musicians.

The Role African Music Play in Nation Building in Nigeria

The role African music play in nation building according to Ali (2013) cannot be underestimated in that African music could be term as the 'mouth-piece' of the nation because; African music does not only educate, entertain and inform, it also does the following:

1. African music preaches Freedom and Need for a democratic society.
2. African music preaches Justice and Equality in our society.
3. African music preaches Unity in our societies.

Ali further noted that African music plays a pivotal role in facilitating national integration and cultivating a sense of cohesion among the various populace of Nigeria. It serves as the primary means of communication for the human spirit. The enjoyment derived from music is one of the most valuable presents we can bestow upon ourselves. It exerts a significant influence on the human psyche. The music's wonderful pulse harmonises frictional and passionate ideas and sentiments. The significance of music in fostering national cohesion is immeasurable. The national anthem of Nigeria is an aesthetically pleasing composition that serves the purpose of fostering unity within the country (Ali, 2013).

Collectively, individuals from many religious beliefs, cultural backgrounds, and linguistic groups engage in singing the song. This tends to help bring the country closer together. Music, without even a doubt, is the closest comparison to the infinite and the essence of things since it is entirely dependent on the ethereal vehicle. African music enhances and harmonises emotions. It educates the soul by purifying and maintaining its self-controlled, profound, harmonious motions. Learning a great art like music calms emotions. African music is subtle and delicate, and it makes mental movement complex and delicate (Banisudha, 2024).

Conclusion

Educating an individual, a community, or an entire nation is fundamentally a process of knowledge transmission and cultural reproduction. Education is not merely the mechanical transfer of information but involves the shaping of identities, values, and worldviews that collectively define a people's approach to life and their relationship with their environment. For the African, education cannot be complete without exploration of music and dance with their related art forms coming together as a holistic process. Given that every geo-physical region is marked by distinct historical trajectories, social structures, ecological realities, and philosophical orientations, it is imperative that any educational process intended to address human and environmental challenges be firmly grounded in the indigenous cultural values and epistemologies of the specific community in question.

This paper posits that there is a mutual complementarity between African music and morality which must be inculcated in education. Today African music is invaded from all angles by western influences. There are noticeable cultural borrowing and lending among different nations of the world. Some music types in the rural communities have lost their contextual and educational usage, concepts and affect, and are now performed more on prestige and entertainment values. It is also true that most of the rural... Audiences have lost trend of the socio-cultural and religious implications, meaning, and story-interests embedded in most performances, symbolic costumes, instruments, performance situations, timing and venues.

Nevertheless, what has been happening is development in innovative continuity since the new genres still remain identifiable with the original genres whose contextual usage, meaning and significance have neither been altered nor effaced. Despite these modern changes brought about by foreign influences, Africa stands out as a continent to show that a people can appropriate modern values, modern technology and modern forms of organization without abandoning their traditional culture, and that modernity can be assimilated to a non-European culture without destroying it. In African as well as any other races in the world, music is always therapeutic, emboldening, captivating, inspiring by bringing one nearer to the Divine.

Recommendations

This paper recommends the following:

1. Considering the ultimate underscores the indispensability of African music as a dynamic system of knowledge is in the African mythodology and a catalyst for cultural resilience, and a cornerstone of identity and self-definition in both local and diasporic contexts, it is therefore highly recommended for the improvement on the study of the subject in Nigerian schools for national development.
2. It contends that within the African context, any educational framework that seeks to be truly holistic and transformative must necessarily incorporate music and dance as core components.
3. Consequently, the erosion of indigenous music and practices has led not only to the loss of cultural capital but also to a diminished capacity to address contemporary challenges in ways that resonate with local realities and values; thus a deliberate reintegration of music into educational curricula and community life offers a viable pathway toward cultural revitalisation and socio-economic renewal for national development.

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